

Full Extended Response

Workbook 2 · Apply under realistic timing

Goal

Complete one independent 45-minute response, preserve the timed draft, and review it only after time ends.

Suggested 45-minute plan

0–8 minutes · Read

Map both sources. Circle the evidence that directly tests each recommendation.

8–12 minutes · Plan

Choose the better-supported argument. Outline two reasons and one fair comparison.

12–37 minutes · Draft

Keep the opening short. Spend most of the time explaining evidence.

37–45 minutes · Revise

Check source accuracy, paragraph jobs, sentence boundaries, and vague wording.

Rules for this attempt

Do not read the answer notes before submitting. Stop writing when 45 minutes ends. Keep the timed draft unchanged so your self-review reflects the attempt you actually completed.

This is original practice material. It is not an official GED test or score.

Should the City Lease North Yard for Modular Housing?

Writing task

Analyze both sources. Determine which argument is better supported by relevant evidence and reasoning. Use specific evidence from the sources to support your response.

Use only the information in the two sources. Judge which argument is better supported; do not argue from personal preference.

Source A

Use North Yard for Housing Now

The Housing Access Coalition asks the city to lease the vacant North Yard parcel for a modular housing project as soon as possible. The coalition notes that 1,840 households are currently on the city's supportive-housing waiting list and that the parcel is within a ten-minute walk of two bus routes, a grocery store, and a community clinic. It proposes placing about 80 small modular units on the site for five years while permanent affordable housing is developed elsewhere.

The coalition points to a project in another city where 96 modular units opened within nine months after approval. It argues that factory-built units can be installed faster than conventional apartments and estimates that the North Yard project could accept residents within one year. A nonprofit developer has provided a preliminary estimate of \$14 million for units, site work, and three years of operating support, but the estimate assumes that existing water, sewer, and electrical connections are adequate. The coalition has not completed a utility-capacity study or a soil investigation for the parcel.

Coalition members also argue that leaving public land unused has a cost. The parcel has been vacant for seven years, and the city spends about \$38,000 annually on fencing, weed control, and security. The proposal would require the housing operator to maintain the property during the lease. The coalition acknowledges that the transportation department has previously discussed using North Yard for future fleet facilities, but it says no construction money has been approved for that idea. It recommends signing a five-year lease now with a clause allowing the city to reclaim the land at the end of the term. The coalition argues that an urgent housing need should outweigh an unfunded long-term possibility.

Original content by Chee Skool

Source B

Reserve North Yard and Use the Alternate Parcel

The city transportation director recommends keeping North Yard available for a replacement bus-maintenance facility and locating temporary modular housing on a different public parcel. Her department's current five-year capital plan identifies North Yard as the preferred site because the existing maintenance depot sits partly in a flood-prone area and cannot fit the larger electric buses the agency has begun ordering. A site study completed last year found that North Yard already has the heavy electrical service, industrial road access, and turning radius needed for a depot. Engineers estimated that preparing another industrial parcel for the same use would add about \$9 million in utility and access work.

The director does not argue that temporary housing should be rejected. She identifies a city-owned parcel 1.2 kilometers away that is also near bus service and a clinic. A utility review for that site found sufficient water and sewer capacity for approximately 60 modular units, and a preliminary environmental screen found no contamination requiring cleanup. The alternative parcel is smaller, so it would house fewer residents than the coalition's North Yard concept. It would also require about \$1.6 million in new electrical and sidewalk work.

The transportation department estimates that converting North Yard to housing for five years could delay the replacement depot because the agency expects to seek construction funding within two budget cycles. The housing lease would also require removing utility connections and foundations before depot work could begin; planners estimate that removal at \$1.2 million, although the amount could change after a detailed housing design exists. The director proposes reserving North Yard, beginning design work for the depot, and negotiating with housing providers on the alternative parcel. She acknowledges that this plan produces fewer housing units, but argues that it addresses the housing need without giving up a site whose transportation value has already been tested through engineering work.

Original content by Chee Skool

Timed planner · Stop after 4 minutes

Decision	Better-supported source: _____
Reason 1	_____ _____
Exact evidence	_____ _____
Analysis	Why this evidence matters: _____ _____
Reason 2	_____ _____
Exact evidence	_____ _____
Other source	Fair point + weakness/limit: _____ _____

Time check

Start drafting by minute 12 even if the plan is not written in complete sentences.

Timed response · Page 1

Write the response you would submit. Continue on the next page.

Timed response · Page 2

Stop when 45 minutes ends. Do not erase or rewrite the timed draft during self-review.

Self-review · Score only visible evidence

Choose 0, 1, or 2 for each trait. These are provisional self-review levels, not an official score.

Trait 1 · Argument and evidence

0 = missing/unclear · 1 = partly developed · 2 = clear and consistently supported

My level: 0 / 1 / 2

Evidence from my draft: _____

Trait 2 · Development and organization

0 = missing/unclear · 1 = partly controlled · 2 = clear and logically developed

My level: 0 / 1 / 2

Evidence from my draft: _____

Trait 3 · Clarity and standard English

0 = frequent interference · 1 = uneven control · 2 = clear, controlled sentences

My level: 0 / 1 / 2

Evidence from my draft: _____

One reasoning change for my next attempt: _____

One clarity/editing change for my next attempt: _____

Answer notes · Open after self-review

A defensible decision

Source B is better supported because it uses site-specific engineering and cost evidence for North Yard and offers a tested alternative parcel for temporary housing.

High-value evidence

A site study found that North Yard already has the electrical service, road access, and turning radius needed for a replacement bus depot, while preparing another industrial parcel would add about \$9 million. The alternative housing parcel has documented water and sewer capacity for about 60 units and a preliminary environmental screen.

Fair treatment of Source A

Source A establishes an urgent need with a 1,840-household waitlist and a relevant example of modular units opening quickly. Its North Yard schedule and \$14 million estimate remain uncertain because the parcel has no completed utility-capacity or soil study.

Model analytical paragraph: Source B is stronger because it supports North Yard's transportation value with evidence specific to that parcel. A completed site study found the heavy electrical service, industrial access, and turning radius needed for a bus depot, and engineers estimate that preparing a different industrial site would add about \$9 million. Those findings directly explain why reserving North Yard matters. Source A reasonably emphasizes the housing waitlist, but its cost and one-year opening schedule assume that North Yard's utilities are adequate even though no capacity or soil study has been completed.

Compare the model's functions with your own response: decision, exact evidence, why-it-matters analysis, and fair comparison. Do not copy its wording into the timed draft.